

## **Mistakes in Dashboard Design Transcript**

We will now look at the common mistakes while making dashboards. Generally, 13 types of mistakes are identified which are commonly made by analysts while designing dashboards. First and foremost, the problem with the dashboard design is the analyst does not think that it has to be a single continuous space.

We have started our class by saying that dashboard should be small, concise and clear and should fit into a small space and give clear insights. Generally, it exceeds the boundary of the single screen. Today, the data visualisation tools, especially Power BI or Tableau would always recommend you a fixed ratio in which you can make your data visualisation screen and it also asks to customise it to the mobile viewing platform.

Depending upon the viewing platform for your audience, you should need to customise your visual space so that it feels continuous to the audience and again supplying inadequate context for the data. So, you can put a lot of visuals, if they are not falling together into one context or they are not driving towards one context, the person might not be able to draw insights that you want him to draw. He might draw something else or once he might misinterpret the insights and take a wrong action.

This is very critical especially in designing the operational dashboards where people might take actions which have real world consequences depending upon the cues they are getting from the dashboard. So, the context should be clearly understood between the designer of the dashboard and the user of the dashboard so that the intended actions and insights are seamlessly connected. Then you have the problem of displaying excessive detail or precision.

When there is no need for giving the basic details, you should not allow your dashboard to drill down to the basic level. When your focus is strategy, you need to deal with aggregate data. When your focus is operational, you might need transaction level data.

This amount of balance has to come and you should not over provide information or provide too much precision which can increase the load on the dashboard and bring down its performance. Then choosing a deficient measure or a wrong measure for a visual. This we have seen in our effective visual design.

You have to use the right chart type for the right purpose at hand. Similarly, choosing inappropriate display media and unattractive display. So, we will talk about this little later.

The display medium also becomes very important whether you are trying to showcase it as a live presentation or whether it has interactivity features which are disturbing.



Sometimes there need not be any interaction where you provide some that can be also causing. When there is no need for interactivity, if you provide interactivity, it can also cause break in cognition for the audience and that might again bring down the effectiveness of the visual.

So, introducing meaningless variety, using poorly designed display media and these four features almost all are similar in the sense they have different applications. Choosing inappropriate display media or using unattractive visual display, introducing meaningless variety and using poorly designed display media are certain problems that come up because people use readymade custom visuals without thinking through the applicability on the particular design at hand. For example, certain visualisations might not be appropriate but look very attractive.

You might think that using them would make your dashboard look more authentic or more sophisticated but always remember the principle simplicity in communicating data is the most effective way to do it. So, you should always ask whether the display medium or the attractiveness that you are bringing it, bringing on to the dashboard is actually helping you to communicate more effectively. If not, just go with the simple design.

Then encoding quantitative data inaccurately like using the wrong axis or scale or using the wrong geometric shape for the phenomenon that you want to convey, it can also lead to inappropriate conclusions being drawn by the audience. Again arranging data poorly, you should always try to follow the natural order that is there in the data set or follow the convention when Mitch Schumann pursue the data, try to follow one of this order so that intuitively the dashboard is speaking to the audience. And excessive use of highlighting or not at all highlighting the main data, fluttering the display with useless decorations with border, highlighting the borders, colouring the borders, giving unnecessary background colours, and finally misusing of colour find features.

We will see the implications of making these mistakes in our experiential learning session and try to avoid them in making our visuals and dashboards much effective and better.

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